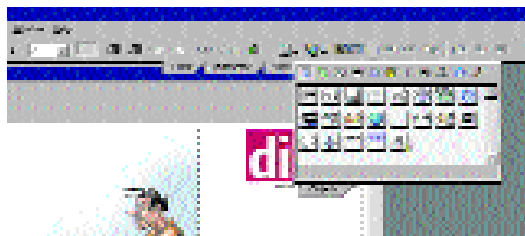


Also, even though GoLive 6.0 does have more palettes than Dreamweaver MX, which offer more contextual settings, you are often left searching for that specific tool you need. We even tried using a few standard shortcut keys with both these software but certain expected shortcuts were missing from Adobe GoLive.



GoLive 6.0 allows you to dock individual palettes as single menu items

The Macromedia team has got it just right; the interface is flexible and can be customised to suit even the fussiest user—you can even go back to the look and feel of Dreamweaver 4.0's interface! This only shows that Macromedia is completely tuned in to the interface requirements of Web designers, but Adobe GoLive has a lot of catching up to do. The purity and simplicity of an interface is almost independent from the core functionality of a product and this is where GoLive could've really upstaged Macromedia, but it fails to do so.

Ease of use

A quick-start to site development with the help of site-building wizards, templates, sample code and code libraries is always welcome. Tools enabling faster execution and shorter project cycles were our primary criteria here.

The first thing that will catch your eye is the all-new File Explorer in Macromedia Dreamweaver MX. It enables quick browsing for assets and files on the desktop and network volumes, without the need to launch your Operating System's file explorer.



The introduction of Code Hints in Dreamweaver MX considerably speeds up writing code

er. Most professionals would appreciate this feature as they can manage their files without having to switch windows. Surprisingly, Adobe has included this feature in Photoshop but not in GoLive 6.0.

To make things simpler, Dreamweaver MX allows you to select HTML elements straight from the status bar (this feature existed in all previous versions of Dreamweaver). However while using GoLive you will have to wade through the menus to locate this feature.

Another all-new addition in Dreamweaver MX is the Snippets Panel, which stores pieces of code for later reuse. Dreamweaver also contains quite a few predefined snippets that you can use. This can instantaneously solve complicated design problems and you can save layouts or functions for future projects. You can create and insert snippets of HTML, JavaScript, CFML, ASP, JSP, and more.

Dreamweaver MX also comes with robust code editing support that makes every coder's life a little easy. Code Hints let you code as you type. When you are in code view, the software automatically provides relevant code for you to select the appropriate tag attributes, methods properties, functions, parameters and Cascading Style Sheet (CSS) styles. This tremendously speeds up and eases coding. Moreover, you can also add your own tags to the library. GoLive, on the other hand, has only a minimal library of sample JavaScript functions.

Smart Objects allows designers to quickly and easily integrate Photoshop, Illustrator, and Flash assets with drag and drop simplicity within GoLive itself. Both Dreamweaver MX and GoLive 6.0 feature helpful site setup wizards and sport a template architecture, but Dreamweaver allows you to define editable, optional and repeating regions for these templates.

With its superior interface, nifty additions like the Snippets Panel and Code Hints, loads of sample code and templates, Dreamweaver MX provides you with all the tools you need to become more productive.

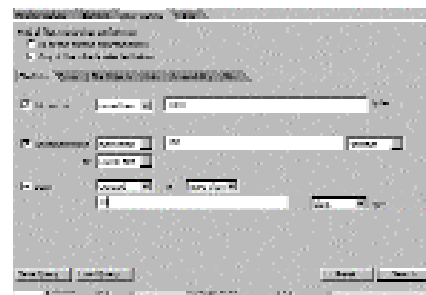
Server-side support

Advanced Web development makes use of server-side scripting languages to build dynamic Web applications. Such functionality is directly built into

Dreamweaver MX and it supports a bunch of server-side code libraries like ColdFusion, ASP, ASP.NET, JSP and PHP. GoLive supports ASP, JSP and PHP, but its PHP support was far more robust than that in Dreamweaver MX.

Dreamweaver MX has native support for editing XHTML documents as well as XML files with arbitrary DTDs (document type definitions). In GoLive 6.0 there's support for a variety of form submission behaviours for ASP, JSP, and PHP databases, including dynamic creation of popup menus, lists, and radio buttons, and the facility to update, delete and add records. Dreamweaver MX features an integrated database panel, and you can drag database objects directly onto a page, whereas in GoLive, you will have to create an object and then bind it to the database element.

Both software had good debugging capabilities wherein they let you check for invalid bindings and examine server-side code for errors. The site reporting capabilities of GoLive are better than Dreamweaver's and it can generate a whole bunch of additional details such as listing out large files that might slow down a page, images with missing attributes, usage of fonts and colours, listing of external links, etc.



GoLive 6.0 offers detailed site reporting capabilities

As an advanced Web development tool there is little that Dreamweaver MX lacks. GoLive, on the other hand, has support for all the major technologies but the implementation is still lacking in some areas.

Integration with other tools and technologies

Web sites today are made up of various elements from different applications and integration with other tools is becoming increasingly important as it's cumbersome to switch between programs in order to generate and access specialised media assets.

With Dreamweaver MX you can